

Anika Mahajan

ATLAS Institute
Boulder, Colorado

anika-mahajan.github.io
anika.mahajan@colorado.edu

EDUCATION

University of Colorado, Boulder Aug 2024 –
PhD in Creative Technology and Design

University of California, Santa Cruz Sept 2019 – June 2023
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science: Computer Game Design
- Minors: Astrophysics and Computer Science

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

ACME Lab, University of Colorado, Boulder
Graduate Research Assistant Aug 2024 –

Center for Transformational Play, Carnegie Mellon University
Research Assistant Jan 2024 – Jun 2024

ALT Games Lab, University of California, Santa Cruz
Undergraduate Research Assistant Oct 2020 – Oct 2023

Creative Coding Lab, University of California, Santa Cruz
Undergraduate Research Assistant Jan 2021 – Apr 2021

PUBLICATIONS

Marjorie Ann Cuervo, **Anika Mahajan**, Josh Mao, and Edward Melcer. (2023). "[Try Again?: A Macro-Level Taxonomy of the Challenge and Failure Process in Games](#)". In 2023 IEEE Conference on Games (CoG). IEEE.

Marjorie Ann Cuervo, **Anika Mahajan**, and Edward Melcer. (2021). "[Die-r Consequences: Player Experience and the Design of Failure through Respawning Mechanics](#)". In 2021 IEEE Conference on Games (CoG). IEEE.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory, Livermore, CA
NIF Computing Scholar Intern July - Sept 2022
- Researching and testing new technologies to connect Java and Python at runtime to modernize their image processing

NIF Computing Scholar Intern *June - Sept 2021*
- Creating a complete Application Program Interface (API) in Java with full documentation and an example class for the Status Verifier to improve automated testing and increase availability

NIF Computing Scholar Intern *June - Sept 2020*
- Redesigning the Status Verifier, a mission critical application, in Java for the National Ignition Facility based on the Model-View-Controller design pattern

UCSC Campus Natural Reserve, Santa Cruz, CA
Automated Camera Trap Processing Internship *Oct - Dec 2020*
- Creating an application to automatically detect animal presence within camera trap photos to speed processing of hundreds of camera trap images

HONORS, GRANTS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

RIO Arts and Humanities Grant , CU Boulder – \$3,500	2025
- Principal Investigator: John Keller	
Dr. Awtar and Teji Singh Fellowship , CU Boulder – \$18,000	2024
Cum Laude , UCSC	2023
Highest Honors in the Major , UCSC	2023
Phi Beta Kappa , Phi Beta Kappa Upsilon Chapter at UCSC	2023
Koret Scholar , Koret Foundation – \$2,000	2022

POSTERS

Algorithmic Game Theory
OurCS: Women in Tech Workshop, Carnegie Mellon University Oct 2022

Fail and Retry: A Taxonomy of Player Challenge and Failure in Virtual Reality Games
Koret Slam, University of California, Santa Cruz May 2022

ORGANIZATIONS

Slug Shelter , <i>Officer</i>	Jan 2021 – Sept 2021
Girls Who Code , <i>Member</i>	Aug 2016 – Present